



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Ghana: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-05

Edition of 2026-08-10 · 129 systems and instruments tracked, 9 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-10 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 129 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 60 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-05, 24 did not, 35 carry no stated baseline, and 9 are Not held at both ends. A further 1 took a position dated after 2026-08-05 and are carried in the status report rather than compared here.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 269 sources for this place in the window – 56 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 213 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* – a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* – a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* – an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* – the programme ended. *No change* – the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* – the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Over the twelve months Ghana went from a jurisdiction with a data-protection law to one with an operating, multi-regulator instrument stack – built mostly by directive and notice rather than by Parliament. The shape check above records the coverage cliff: the comparison rests heavily on the window's later half, and rows whose only source is recent but which describe long-standing systems carry their position from earlier rather than as movement.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
5G spectrum request for applications	Did not exist	Eleven lots across 700 MHz, 2.3 GHz and 3 GHz on a US\$230m aggregate reserve and 15-year licences, amended in seven places by a consolidated response of 2026-07-31; no award made	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Annual fibre cuts	About 400 cuts a year in the early fibre-deployment years, undated	Over 8,000 cuts a year, with one sabotage and roadworks episode disrupting 157 sites	REGRESSED
Cell-site build for 2026	223 new sites a year on the ten-year average	1,150 new sites planned for 2026 across two operators	ADVANCED
Ghana-Burkina Faso frequency coordination agreement	No agreement with Burkina Faso	Coordination agreement finalised with agreed cross-border signal-strength thresholds, in response to consumer interference complaints	ADVANCED
MTN Ghana capital expenditure	<i>Baseline not held</i>	GHS 2,100.4m combined capital expenditure, down 36.3% on a restated GHS 3,298.7m, with intensity falling from 29.1% to 14.0%	REGRESSED
MTN Ghana capital programme	US\$1bn over five years	US\$1.1bn equivalent over 2026 to 2028, with a first tranche of US\$380m for 2026	ADVANCED
NGIC exclusive wholesale 5G licence	Sole licensed wholesale 5G operator, having already missed its June 2025 launch deadline	Exclusivity deleted by regulator amendment under the licence and the Electronic Communications Act; the rest of the licence and the spectrum assignment retained	CLOSED
Rural coverage schedule for the dominant operator	Did not exist	40% of the rural population by 2029-12-01, 60% by 2032-12-01 and 80% by 2035-12-01, technology-neutral and non-retrospective	REGRESSED, MILESTONES PUSHED OUT
Satellite internet subscriptions	11,982 in the first quarter of 2025	15,384 in the second quarter of 2025, from 2,666 before satellite licensing	ADVANCED
Seventy per cent population coverage obligation	Did not exist	A licence condition on every 5G licensee to reach 70% of the total population on or before 2027-03-06 against the 2021 census, with a 90%-of-locality verification rule, confirmed band- and technology-neutral	ADVANCED
Shared 5G wholesale network	Licensed but not launched, with a June 2025 launch deadline missed	Ghana's first shared 5G wholesale network live, its operator demoted from sole wholesaler to one participant	ADVANCED
Significant-market-power spectrum premium	Did not exist	A 40% uplift on the dominant operator's 700 MHz and 3 GHz reserve prices, applied to the reserve only and not to bid ranking, with the regulator declining to publish its valuation model during a live assignment	ADVANCED
Transfer of the country-code domain to state control	Privately managed since 1996; no transfer proposed	Transfer to a state domain registry announced, with automatic assignment to newly registered businesses; no instrument, date or transfer step on record	ADVANCED
Regulator quarterly telecom statistics	The July to September 2024 bulletin the latest issue, published about eight months after the quarter	Still the latest issue held; it records 38.47m mobile voice subscriptions at 116.84% penetration, 25.56m mobile data subscriptions, one operator on 75.09% of the market and fixed broadband down 6.83% in the quarter to 216,143	NO CHANGE
Satellite licensing framework	Licensed and operating, framework in force	29 satellite licences issued, eleven of them last-mile; nothing published on the framework since	NO CHANGE
Submarine carrier services authorisation	In force since November 2024	Unchanged; a five-year renewable authorisation granted under section 3(c) of the National Communications Authority Act 2008, charging an annual regulatory fee of 1% of revenue, lapsing if not operated within two years, requiring not less than three years' notice of non-renewal, and obliging the holder to retain charging and financial data for six years and regulatory returns for two	NO CHANGE
Dig Once policy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Draft framework finalised with the roads ministry and implementation targeted for the third quarter of 2026; no cabinet decision, instrument or commencement on record	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Register of authorised internet service providers	BASELINE NOT HELD	78 authorised internet and public-data providers of which 42 are operational and 36 are not, with 35 of the 73 companies in the main internet and public-data class not operational and the single authorised rural provider itself not operational	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Digital Realty Accra data centre	Did not exist	Commissioned at up to 1.7 MW IT load and 500 racks, carrier-neutral and connected to a subsea landing	ADVANCED
National AI Compute Centre	Did not exist	US\$250m announced by the President at the 2026-04-24 strategy launch, the larger of two dollar commitments totalling US\$270m made that day; no site, operator, procurement route or date	ADVANCED
Africa Data Centres Accra facility	Announced at 10 MW initial capacity expandable to 30 MW on about US\$100m of equity and development finance, construction due 2024	Unchanged; the first phase was due within 12 to 18 months of a 2024 start and no operational date, delay or cancellation is on file	NO CHANGE
Agility Logistics Park data-centre campus	BASELINE NOT HELD	30 MW of committed IT capacity, designed for expansion to 150 MW	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Commercial data-centre live IT load	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 4.8 MW of live critical IT load across 8 to 10 commercial facilities in 2024, against 7 MW in construction, about 60% occupancy and about US\$12m of annual commercial revenue	<i>Baseline not held</i>
National Data Centre	BASELINE NOT HELD	Being modernised to support AI workloads; no capacity, location, cost, contractor or timetable stated	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Submarine cable inventory	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regulator names five submarine cable providers - SAT-3, MainOne, WASC, Glo and ACE - on an undated page resting the licence on section 3(8) of the Electronic Communications Act 2008; an analyst brief counts six cables landing at Accra and about 2.5 Tbps of international capacity in use (2024 estimate)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Community media cyber capability project	Did not exist	Czech-funded and implemented with the cyber-security authority and a digital-transformation centre, training about 60 media houses and more than 100 journalists in Accra through August 2026 and in Kumasi in September, and certifying those who complete every session and file a report into a proposed cyber-security press corps	ADVANCED
Critical information infrastructure designation	Did not exist	The communications minister says all central-bank-licensed entities will soon be designated critical information infrastructure; no instrument, date or designation list published	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Cross-network mobile-money fraud monitoring	Did not exist	A centralised real-time layer able to block suspicious transfers as they move between networks, described as under discussion and nothing built	ADVANCED
Commercial AI-driven security operations centre	Operating from May 2025 as a commercial AI-driven security and digital-forensics centre	Unchanged; no client count, throughput or incident figure published since launch	NO CHANGE
Cybersecurity Act 2020	In force as the cybersecurity statute, text not held	Unchanged; the text is now held - it establishes the Cyber Security Authority and a Cybersecurity Fund, provides for designation, registration and compliance audit of critical information infrastructure, and licenses cybersecurity service providers	NO CHANGE
National computer emergency response team	Operating as a unit of the cyber-security authority	Unchanged; a 24-hour incident-response service with a constituency of eight sectoral response teams and the general public, affiliated to the Budapest Convention	NO CHANGE
Financial Industry Security Operations Centre	BASELINE NOT HELD	Expansion to all financial institutions including fintechs and microfinance announced in March 2026; four months later a digital-economy forum still lists complete onboarding as a recommendation	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Joint Cyber Security Committee	BASELINE NOT HELD	Eighteen institutions, chaired by the cyber-security authority	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The clearest band change in this report is the 5G market. At the window's opening one operator held an exclusive wholesale licence and had already missed a June 2025 launch deadline. By July 2026 that exclusivity had been deleted after a full statutory objection sequence, a shared wholesale network had gone live in March, and a priced multi-lot competitive assignment was running with coverage obligations, a market-power premium and a published timetable — a move from monopoly design to open market with a number on it.

Data centres moved once, and in the opposite direction to the announcements. A commercial facility was commissioned between October and November 2025 at up to 1.7 MW and 500 racks; a facility announced in 2023 at 10 MW expandable to 30 MW has produced no dated status at all since; and the largest facility on the record entered the base in July 2026 through pan-African trade press with no Ghanaian primary behind it.

Cyber-security is where the base thickened most and matured least. At the start it held one commercial security operations centre; it now holds a central-bank directive, a named sectoral operations centre, an eighteen-institution coordinating committee and a journalist-training project — and still no national computer emergency response team, no Cybersecurity Act text and no incident statistics.

The rest is accretion on a network-quality problem the base already recognised: over 8,000 fibre cuts a year, and half-year capital expenditure down 36.3% at the operator carrying most of the build.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Mobile money interoperability	Instant-pay value of GH¢120.1bn in 2023, with the interoperable share of the market not stated	33.5m transactions worth GH¢6.2bn in June 2026, about 1.3% of total mobile-money value	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Biometric SIM re-registration	SIM registration moved fully online from June 2025	A fresh nationwide biometric drive still not begun, with the 2021 to 2023 registration declared invalid and the 2022 biometrics confirmed never authenticated against the identity database	STALLED
Ghana Card	About 18m adults registered, with a printed-card backlog outstanding and applications moved online	19.2m registered aged 15 and over, 262 institutions integrated, instant issuance nationwide and eleven overseas missions	ADVANCED
Ghana Card enrolment for children aged 6 to 14	A plan announced to capture 7m under-fifteens and 3m diaspora	3.1m children targeted, phased at 21 days per region, run jointly with the health insurance authority	ADVANCED
Ghana Card photocopy ban and verification service	Did not exist	A three-month transition from 27 July to 2 November 2026 for banks, telecoms operators, hospitals, schools, insurers and agencies, with a sanctions ladder to suspension of verification access and licence withdrawal	ADVANCED
National Identity Register Amendment Regulations 2026	Did not exist; the 2012 regulations as amended in 2018 were the standing rules	Biometric-only verification is law, visual inspection and photocopying are barred, and penalties run to 2,000 penalty units for an organisation	ADVANCED
Paid 24-hour identity service centre	Did not exist	A paid tier operating around the clock, all services attracting approved charges, the first of several planned nationwide	ADVANCED
Ghana Card as sole banking identity	BASELINE NOT HELD	Primary and sole identity document for financial onboarding at all regulated institutions, with biometric and liveness checks	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Active mobile money users, dominant operator	<i>Baseline not held</i>	19.3m at 31 December 2025 against 18.3m at 30 June 2026, with neither source stating the definition	REGRESSED, BASIS NOT ESTABLISHED
Digital credit service provider regime	Did not exist	A September 2025 directive in force from 1 November 2025, with applications from that month, the deadline elapsed and twenty unlicensed apps named on 2026-08-03	ADVANCED
Electronic money issuer licence revocation	A licensed dedicated electronic money issuer and development-finance investee	Licence revoked for electronic money not fully cash-backed, with premises access restricted by the central bank and police	CLOSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Mobile money subsidiary separation	Did not exist	The mobile-money subsidiary files its own condensed statements inside the parent's report and declared its own interim dividend	ADVANCED
Mobile money transaction value	6.81bn transactions worth GH¢1.92tn in the full year 2023	GH¢492.9bn on 954m transactions in June 2026 alone, up about 52% on June 2025	ADVANCED
Pan-African payment system participation	A fintech-routed connection live under a six-month central-bank pilot	National gateway designated, a second bank live in-app, and a naira corridor from February 2026	ADVANCED
Registered and active mobile-money wallets	76.4m registered wallets in June 2025	84.6m registered and 26.4m active at 90 days in June 2026, with wallet float at a record GH¢40bn from GH¢28.9bn, and one million registered agents of whom 546,000 are active	ADVANCED
Renminbi settlement access	Did not exist	Direct settlement in renminbi from cedi accounts, in real time or batch, without correspondent-bank intermediation	ADVANCED
Register of licensed digital credit providers	Did not exist	Still unpublished, with a twenty-name blacklist of unlicensed apps published instead	NO CHANGE
Central bank digital currency pilot	BASELINE NOT HELD	Pilot stage with the focus pivoted to cross-border settlement for sub-regional trade; no rollout date	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Births and deaths registry digitisation	Decentralised printing across 470 offices in 261 districts with electronically signed certificates, and 881,000 copies needed to clear the backlog	Unchanged; nothing dated since	NO CHANGE
Land cadastre digitalisation	A fit-for-purpose cadastre programme expected to commence in 2023	Unchanged; no dated progress on file	NO CHANGE
Business registration platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	End-to-end filing from name search to certification with no physical submission, integrating with national identification for verification	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Land Use Planning and Management Information System	BASELINE NOT HELD	Being redeveloped into a web-based platform for spatial planning, development control and street addressing, with data sharing and interoperability against existing government systems consulted on; carried inside a spatial-planning sub-programme appropriated GHS 36,454,968 for 2026, from which no digital share is separable	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Health management information system	BASELINE NOT HELD	Rollout directed and a vendor engaged; no completion, facility count or coverage figure held since	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Cross-border electronic commerce tax platform	Did not exist	Piloted April 2026 with a named private operator and a first-full-year projection of GH¢3.2bn, which is a projection and not an outturn	ADVANCED
Customs valuation AI system	Did not exist	About 366,000 declarations analysed to 2026-07-17, 24% triggering more than one valuation risk indicator, with collections up 17.5% against a 6.3% rise in declared value	ADVANCED
Ghana.gov services portal	About 1,500 to 2,000 services live against a 16,000 target, with a redesign due in the fourth quarter of 2025	The redesign still not launched and no service count published since July 2025	STALLED
Second public sector reform strategy	Did not exist	Draft on seven pillars, 27 programmes and 135 activities with the identity credential as the spine, expected at cabinet and Parliament by end-2026	ADVANCED
Electronic procurement system	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mandatory end-to-end electronic procurement with pre-disclosed evaluation criteria, integrated with the national payment system	Baseline not held
Fiscal electronic device policy	BASELINE NOT HELD	An advanced pilot under the 2018 fiscal-device Act, to be paired with a reward scheme, with a projection of GH¢7.2bn a year	Baseline not held

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Quarterly employment statistics	None published	Still none published, with a methodology requested in July 2026 and no timetable	NO CHANGE

Identity changed band decisively. A credential became a compulsory verification regime: amendment regulations in force from 9 June 2026 made biometric matching the only lawful means, barred photocopying and retention, and fixed enforcement at 2 November 2026, while the card itself cleared a backlog of more than 640,000 and moved from about 18 million registered adults to 19.2 million with institutions integrated rising from 95 to 262.

Revenue and procurement systems moved from ambition to operating instruments — a customs valuation system fully deployed from March 2026 with a quantified revenue claim, mandatory electronic procurement integrated with the national payment system, and three revenue platforms approved by Parliament in July. Digital credit acquired a licensing regime, a lapsed deadline and an enforcement notice naming twenty applications, none of which existed a year ago.

The payments core itself only accreted detail. The rail was already there and got bigger, better instrumented and better measured: registered wallets from 76.4 million to 84.6 million, float to a record GH¢40bn. The significant new fact is not the growth but the 1.3% interoperable share, which reframes a position the base already held rather than moving it.

Three things went nowhere. The biometric SIM re-registration announced for the first quarter of 2026 has not begun; the services portal redesign promised for the fourth quarter of 2025 has not launched; and a licence-passporting memorandum signed in February 2025 is where it was — signed, unpublished, unreadable.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange Act	None published	Named by the ministry as a statute distinct from harmonisation, carrying interoperability and inter-agency sharing, with no draft or timetable	ADVANCED
Data Harmonisation Bill	Named as a forthcoming Act the new board must support, with no draft	Consulted on and still a bill, renamed an Act in the July 2026 AI plan, not laid before Parliament	ADVANCED
Electronic Transactions Bill 2025	The 2008 electronic transactions Act as the standing baseline, with no replacement on record	A draft that would mandate age verification for child-accessible services, ban targeted advertising to children and impose risk assessments and semi-annual transparency reports on very large platforms	ADVANCED
SIM re-registration legislative instrument	<i>Baseline not held</i>	Still not laid on file, with the first-quarter 2026 start date passed and a later-in-2026 rollout restated in February	STALLED
Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025	No statute, with more than 3 million virtual-asset users and over 100 service providers recorded in a July 2025 registration exercise, and regulated institutions directed not to facilitate virtual-asset activity at all	In force on the regulator's account, risk-based and technology-neutral with capital adequacy, client-asset custody and anti-money-laundering duties, supervision split between the central bank and the securities regulator by activity, licensing attaching to the service rather than to holding, virtual assets excluded from deposit protection and from any statutory compensation fund and barred from invoicing, pricing and wages, transition arrangements for existing operators, and the licensing requirements still being built	ADVANCED
Electronic Communications Act 2008	In force as the licensing statute for electronic communications	Unchanged; the statute under which 5G licences and submarine-cable landings are granted, which establishes the universal-access fund and sources it from contributions stipulated in each licence rather than from any rate set in the Act	NO CHANGE
Innovation and Startup Bill	A draft startup law under development, with no text	Still forthcoming, now tied to a national financial-technology fund it would give a legal base and eligibility criteria, with no draft published and none laid	NO CHANGE
Digital banking framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Framework and comprehensive draft guidelines complete, awaiting stakeholder consultation before implementation, with no date	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Digital Economy and Innovation Development Fund Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under legislative review, converting the universal-access fund into a wider digital-infrastructure, innovation and skills fund; levy rate, governance structure and the fate of the rural-access earmark all unestablished	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Emerging Technologies Bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft that would create an emerging-technologies agency for cross-functional compliance across artificial intelligence, blockchain, connected devices, cloud and quantum, with voluntary startup registration	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Identity agency Act amendment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Would place the identity agency permanently under the interior ministry and grant security agencies defined access to the biometric citizen database	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Information technology agency bill	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft that would overhaul the 2008 law, license every technology business, certify professionals, regulate artificial intelligence and blockchain and levy 1% on services, and split the agency's regulatory and commercial arms	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
National AI health policy	Did not exist	A health ministry draft anchored on Article 34(2) of the 1992 Constitution, covering approval, procurement, validation, human oversight, monitoring, evaluation and accountability across public and private facilities, and barring patient data from leaving the country without safeguards; not adopted, and no text published	ADVANCED
National AI implementation plan	Did not exist	Being built with UN partners on measurable annual milestones over a decade, framed against the risk of a shelf document	ADVANCED
National AI Strategy 2023-2033	In preparation with regional and donor partners, not approved or funded	Approved and launched, with the text held from 2026-08-05; a ten-year implementation plan with annual milestones announced 2026-07-29, a National AI Fund of GHS 5bn (2025-2030) scaling to GHS 15bn (2030-2035) in the strategy, and US\$250m plus US\$20m announced separately at the launch	ADVANCED
National Data Strategy	Draft validated July 2024, awaiting adoption	No adoption, publication or implementation step on file in the two years since validation	NO CHANGE
Responsible AI oversight body	Proposed at a national consultation, with no legal basis or timetable	Provided for in the launched strategy, with no establishing instrument, budget or staff sixteen months after first proposal	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Ghana-Rwanda fintech licence passporting memorandum	Signed and announced, text unpublished	Still unpublished by either central bank as at 2026-07-30, so which licence categories are recognised and on what conditions is unestablished	NO CHANGE

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Cyber and Information Security Directive 2026	An earlier directive in force, text and date not held	In force as the country's first comprehensive AI-governance framework for financial institutions, with cloud-security rules, proportionality by size and risk and mandatory board-level accountability	ADVANCED
Government data exchange hub	Launched 2009 and stalled on funding and unclear mandates	Named again by the communications minister as a National Data Exchange Hub government plans to establish for standardised and interoperable sharing between institutions, with no design, cost or timetable stated	ADVANCED, RE-ANNOUNCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Data Protection Commission	Operating under the 2012 Act, with a new governing board sworn in that day and tasked with a national data-governance framework	Operating, with 2026 declared a year of enforcement and a size-banded fee schedule in force from 2026-02-02	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
United States health data-sharing agreement	Did not exist	Offered and refused: a five-year agreement that, on the data-protection regulator's account, covered not only health data sets but metadata, dashboards, reporting tools, data models and data dictionaries, gave ten United States entities access requiring no prior Ghanaian approval, required 25 years of citizens' health records, and settled disputes under United States law against US\$109m subject to congressional appropriation	CLOSED, REFUSED BEFORE SIGNATURE
Data Protection Act 2012	In force as the sole general data-protection statute, with controllers and processors the regulated class	In force and unamended, with a draft replacement published during 2025 and not enacted	NO CHANGE
Data-protection enforcement actions	No enforcement figures published	Still no fine, prosecution or registered-controller count published, twelve months on	NO CHANGE
Upgrade of the data-protection regulator to an authority	Announced by the minister at the board swearing-in, with no bill	Announced, with no bill, no timetable and no further mention on file in twelve months	NO CHANGE
Draft Data Protection Act 2025	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft that would require domestic storage of data critical to national security, civil registration and sensitive personal data including children's, biometric, health and genetic data	Baseline not held

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Ghana-EU digital instrument	A 2021 to 2027 programme with digital folded through three priority areas rather than given its own	Unchanged in shape; the EUR 203m for 2021 to 2024 is followed by EUR 136m for 2025 to 2027 supplied at the mid-term review, split between green growth for jobs EUR 42m, smart and sustainable cities EUR 45m, good governance and security EUR 40m and support measures EUR 9m, with digital again given no priority area of its own	NO CHANGE

At the window's opening this was one statute and one regulator, with a governing board sworn in that very day and a national data strategy validated thirteen months earlier and never adopted. Everything else in this section arrived inside the twelve months: identity regulations in force, a digital-credit directive with two enforcement notices, a central-bank cyber directive, a virtual-assets Act in implementation, an artificial-intelligence strategy approved and funded, a 5G assignment and the deletion of an exclusive licence.

The genuine maturity change is therefore from a jurisdiction with a data-protection law to one with an operating instrument stack — built by directive and notice rather than by Parliament. The second real change is the drafting wave: at the baseline the base held no bill at all, and it now names at least eight distinct proposed instruments and holds the text of none.

What merely accreted detail is the data-protection position itself. A year of awareness campaigns, a size-banded fee schedule, a data-protection week and a declared year of enforcement produced no amendment to the 2012 Act, no enacted successor and no published enforcement figure. Two positions moved backwards while looking active: the SIM re-registration instrument, stated ready to be laid in December 2025 and still not laid, and the identity agency's Act amendment, before Parliament since August 2025 with nothing since. And the regulator's own declared enforcement year is being delivered, on the evidence, by the central bank.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Customs AI attributed revenue	Did not exist	Monthly figures of GH¢73.44m, GH¢51.63m, GH¢72.5m, GH¢55.82m and GH¢35.17m to 17 July, the finance ministry's own and unaudited	ADVANCED
Disaster management AI chatbot	Did not exist	Owned by the national disaster management organisation, answering on floods, fires, storms, droughts, earthquakes, epidemics and localised hazards in several international and local languages and issuing automated responses during an emergency, with officers from ten regional offices trained online on 2026-06-04 and six regions still without an emergency operations centre	ADVANCED
Google Africa applied AI lab	Did not exist	Described by its sponsor as Africa's first applied AI lab, sited at an Accra community centre with research and venture partners; the first cohort is not yet selected	ADVANCED
National AI Strategy document	BASELINE NOT HELD	The Republic of Ghana National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2025-2035, published by the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations and dated December 2025, held in full	<i>Baseline not held</i>

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Micro-enterprise tax platform	Did not exist	Nationwide commercial deployment with the revenue authority, targeting about 530,000 small enterprises onboarded in the first twelve months	ADVANCED
Mobile money intellectual-property claim	Did not exist	Live before the commercial division of the High Court, with the operator saying the claims are without merit and that it will contest fully; no monetary figure pleaded	ADVANCED
Technology sector contribution to output and employment	A single regulator-commissioned satellite account, with data ending in 2014	Unchanged; ICT gross value added of GHS 2,489.3m in 2014 and a share of gross domestic product falling in every year of the series, from 3.1% in 2010 to 2.2% in 2014	NO CHANGE

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Assistive vision technology	A post-hackathon prototype from a 2024 competition	Two devices in pilot, smart glasses and an ultrasonic obstacle detector, at a target price of about GH¢2,000 and a 1,500-user target within a year	ADVANCED
Startup equity funding	US\$9,715,000 across seven startups in 2024	US\$41,225,000 across eight startups in 2025, seventh in Africa and 2.5% of the continental total	ADVANCED

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Google AI research and community centre	Operating, with a US\$37m cumulative investment figure disclosed by the company	Unchanged; it hosts the new applied AI lab and no further Ghana investment figure has been published since	NO CHANGE

At the window's opening Ghana had no adopted artificial-intelligence policy: a draft in consultation, a coders programme four months old, a privately built security centre, and a research centre with a cumulative investment figure disclosed the week before. Nothing was funded and no institution existed.

Three things changed band. The strategy moved from draft to Cabinet-approved in February 2026, to launched with a US\$270m headline in April, to a ten-year implementation plan under construction by July – an object that did not exist a year ago. Artificial intelligence moved from policy to production in one place only, at customs. And the country acquired physical adjacent capacity it did not have, in a commissioned commercial data centre and an approved but unbuilt compute centre.

Everything else accreted detail on a position already held. The oversight body has been planned continuously since April 2025, sixteen months without an establishing instrument, and the private security centre has had no update since its launch. The financing picture is the sharpest divergence: announced money with no disbursement on file, while the sector's largest actual spender cut half-year capital expenditure in the same period it raised a three-year pledge.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Household survey of digital access	A 2019 regulator household survey, with a biennial repeat stated as intent	No repeat round; 16.8% of households with internet access against 73.8% owning a television, 7.9% of people aged five and over owning a computer of any kind, and smartphone ownership at 58.4% urban against 28.1% rural	NO CHANGE
Fourth-generation coverage against usage	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fourth-generation networks reach more than 90% of the population while actual usage runs below 60%, with many users still on feature phones	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Rural telephony and digital inclusion project	BASELINE NOT HELD	Continuing, with the fund restating it as top priority and taking an upgraded mast design	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Universal access fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Still operating as the universal-access fund with the rural telephony project its stated top priority, and slated for conversion	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Unlimited fibre tariff	GH¢987 per month for an unlimited 100 Mbit/s package	GH¢299 per month, with 300 Mbit/s at GH¢444 and 500 Mbit/s at GH¢999	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Cash-grant programme on mobile-money rails	BASELINE NOT HELD	A full-year allocation of GH¢1.1bn, the highest since inception, with a recent cycle releasing about GH¢139m to roughly 350,580 households	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
National privacy awareness campaign	BASELINE NOT HELD	All sixteen regions, delivered in English plus five Ghanaian languages, scheduled to end September 2026	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Revised basic-education curriculum	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced not adopted, to go to the President, then cabinet, then Parliament	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Education fund and UNESCO AI teacher training programme	Did not exist	A memorandum to train teachers and instructors in technical and vocational institutions in digital and AI skills, placed under UNESCO's Global Skills Academy and delivered through a three-month master-trainer cascade ending in examinations, with commercial partners named	ADVANCED
Girls in ICT programme	A two-week residential model in coding, animation, web development, cybersecurity and basic computing, with about 18,000 girls and 1,800 teachers since 2012	An AI module added as the largest curriculum expansion to date, with completers transitioning into the coders programme	ADVANCED
One Million Coders Programme	Launched April 2025 against a target of one million trained by 2030	The first tertiary institution embeds it permanently, with 2,500 laptops delivered and an AI feeder cohort routed into it	ADVANCED
Korean youth leadership programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	200 participants from Ghana, Nigeria, Cote d'Ivoire, Senegal and Cameroon across online training, in-country sessions at a public administration institute and a funded 14-day study visit to Korea for top performers, coupling public governance with AI-driven digital-government innovation	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Youth agency microdegree programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	Government-funded vendor-certified microdegrees in cloud, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data analytics, taking 2,000 of the 3,000 places allocated to Africa, with 600 paid internships and a five-region pilot	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Innovation centre at a public university	BASELINE NOT HELD	An advanced technology innovation centre with a foreign development agency, recorded as active	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The direction here is that capacity grew and its outputs stayed unmeasured. The coders programme was embedded in a university curriculum, an agency signed for 2,000 microdegree places, and a community-media cyber corps launched — and fifteen months after launch the coders programme has published no cumulative number of people trained.

Two things did not move at all. The rural telephony project is described in the same terms in March 2026 as the 2020 loan record describes it, with no disbursement or coverage figure added in between and its last quantified statement a 60.2% disbursement rate as at May 2022. And no dedicated community-network regime exists; the regulator now says an existing authorisation could found one.

Affordability moved once, by ministerial pressure on a single operator rather than by market entry, cutting an unlimited fibre package from GH¢987 to GH¢299 a month in June 2026. Two Chinese distance-learning loans signed in October 2020 passed their expected completion dates during the window with no completion, disbursement or outturn statement on file, one of them flagged for indications of financial underperformance.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Digital acceleration project	US\$200m committed, with the services portal to add about 16,000 services in the fourth quarter of 2025	Still named as a pillar of the digital agenda; the portal target has no delivery statement on file, and US\$18.3m had been disbursed	NO CHANGE
AI implementation fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$20m earmarked for short-to-medium-term implementation, with no appropriation, disbursement or managing body named	Baseline not held
National financial-technology fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	To be aligned with a forthcoming innovation and startup framework that would set eligibility and give the fund a legal basis	Baseline not held

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-05	MOVEMENT
Domestic digital-transformation appropriation	BASELINE NOT HELD	GHS 729,947,850 for ICT Infrastructure, Regulation and Capacity Building, of which GHS 591,947,850 is domestically funded, and GHS 100,000,000 for ICT Capacity Development, under the communications ministry's 2026 vote; the domestic figure resolves to GHS 536,745,448 for the information technology agency, GHS 25,346,198 for the cyber-security authority, GHS 17,308,560 for the ICT capacity centre, GHS 9,720,400 for the data-protection regulator and GHS 2,827,244 for the domain registry	Baseline not held
Multi-year commitment for three revenue platforms	BASELINE NOT HELD	Approved with published benefit projections and no disclosed cost, contract duration or termination terms	Baseline not held

(narrative not yet written)

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre power arrangements	this subject is effectively empty for the country; probed 2026-08-05, no power purchase or supply arrangement is published; an analyst market brief maps the facilities and their power constraints	2026-08-05

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Ghana Card payment functionality	probed 2026-08-05, trade press reported an activated card wallet in early April 2026 and the issuing authority denied it on 8 April 2026	2026-08-05
Local government electronic services	a district service platform, or a local-government digitisation report, would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, the ministry's programme-based estimates document the district data platform and MMDA integration	2026-08-05
National open-data instrument	a published policy or a live inventory would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, the 2016 open data policy located; the live inventory exists separately; the 2016 policy acquired on 2026-08-05 turned out to be the GHEITI extractives policy, not a national instrument, so a national open-data instrument remains unestablished	2026-08-05
Ghana-India technology cooperation instrument	a bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit record or an Indian vendor contract would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, a joint trade committee discussed a possible digital MoU in May 2024; no signed instrument was located	2026-08-05
Ghana-Gulf technology investment instrument	a sovereign-fund agreement, or a data-centre or AI memorandum, would settle it; probed 2026-08-05, the May 2025 innovation hub memorandum is reported with a component breakdown but its text is not published	2026-08-05
Community network licensing framework	a civil-society policy lead places four other African states ahead of Ghana on enabling frameworks; probed 2026-08-05, no dedicated community-network licence exists; the authorised-ISP list defines the classes such a network must fit	2026-08-05
Distance-learning loan for tertiary institutions	connects satellite campuses to fibre; borrowing terms unknown; probed 2026-08-05, the loan agreement is unpublished; terms appear only in a research database, which is a lead rather than a source	2026-08-05
Distance-learning loan for a local government institute	the country announced sovereign default in December 2022; probed 2026-08-05, two attempts surfaced no distance-learning loan to a local-government institute	2026-08-05

The absences below did not close during the period, and two of them frame the rest: there is no domestic state budget for Ghana in the compiled finance layer at all, and the regulator has published no quarterly telecom statistics since the second quarter of 2024. Every state financing figure in this report is therefore an announcement rather than an appropriation, and every current market figure comes from a commercial tracker.

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